

Bastion (*Fighter*)

Bastion Fighters have spent countless hours practicing and experimenting with shields. Their ideal is to be defenders, choosing to focus their time and efforts into perfecting the use of shields rather than a traditional weapon. They are the wall, sheltering their allies and breaking the tides of the enemy; no harm shall come to those a bastion protects.

Martial Wall

At 3rd level, you have trained extensively with your shield to become a wall, protecting your allies in a myriad of ways. You gain an additional fighting style from the following options. Each fighting style includes a modification listed beside it; as long as you have that fighting style, regardless of where you obtained it, you can choose to benefit from the modification.

Defense. The benefit increases by one (to a total of +2) if you are using a shield; you can receive this bonus while unarmored as long as you have a shield. Additionally, you gain advantage on any ability checks or saving throws to prevent yourself from being moved against your will or to avoid or end the Grappled condition.

Interception. When you use the reaction granted by this fighting style, you can add your shield's AC bonus—including any magical bonus it may have—to the damage reduction. You can also use this ability without expending your reaction; once you use it in this way, you cannot do so again until the start of your next turn. You can do so in this way twice per turn at level 11 and three times per turn at level 17.

Protection. When you use the reaction granted by this fighting style, you can grant the creature you are protecting the benefits of half-cover until the start of your next turn, as long as you remain within 5 feet of them; this applies to the triggering attack as well. You may also trigger it as a reaction when another creature within 5 feet must make a Dexterity saving throw; they gain advantage on the save instead and may also benefit from the half-cover granted by this modification.

Keeper of Shields

Your extensive training with shields has allowed you to access and use a variety of special shields to their maximum potential. You gain access to the following shield variants: the buckler and the tower shield. These shield variants count as shields for any feature that mentions them, though they may interact differently from the average shield. If you obtain a magic shield, you can spend 8 hours and 25 gold per level of rarity (25 GP for common, 50 GP for uncommon, 75 GP for rare, and so on) to convert it into one of the other variants. You also gain the ability to improvise a shield, similarly to how weapons can be improvised. As usual, you may only receive the AC benefits from one shield at a time; having two different kinds of shields does not allow them to stack. The details for your shield variants and improvised shields are listed below. *Note: These shield variants are available for anyone to use, but without proper training, they function identically to a base shield. A DM can override this and offer these variants as mundane equipment for anyone with the appropriate proficiencies; the suggested method to do so is detailed as a miscellaneous option in chapter 7, titled Shield Variants.*

Buckler: A buckler is a small shield, typically strapped to the arm instead of held. Due to its size, its defensive properties are lower; the AC bonus from this type of shield decreases to +1. However, you can

use the free hand provided by a buckler for anything you could normally use a free hand to do, as it is designed to be unintrusive. If you make a melee attack with a weapon with the *heavy* property, you lose the buckler's AC benefit until the start of your next turn. A buckler weighs half as much as a normal shield and costs 6 GP to purchase.

Tower Shield: Tower shields are much larger and more unwieldy than your average shield. As a Bonus Action, or in place of one of your attacks when you take the Attack Action, you can brace yourself behind a tower shield you are holding. You gain the benefits of half-cover until the start of your next turn, and your movement speed is halved while you are bracing yourself in this way. You can end this effect at any time, no action required. If your Strength score is not at least a 13, all your movement speeds are decreased by 5 feet. A tower shield weighs twice as much as a normal shield and costs 20 GP to purchase. **SPECIAL:** Due to your training as a Bastion, at the start of your turn, if you have not willingly moved more than 5 feet since bracing yourself behind your shield, you can extend the effect without needing to sacrifice an attack or a Bonus Action. You can continue to extend this effect in this way at the start of each of your turns as long as you continue to meet the requirements.

Improvised Shield: Improvised shields are created when an object is used to protect the holder, despite not being intended for such a purpose. An improvised shield requires at least one hand to hold, and you are considered proficient in its use, allowing you to benefit from its AC bonus if you are not already using a shield; improvised shields can only function as standard shields, not as a buckler or a tower shield, unless your DM says otherwise. You may use an improvised shield for any feature you have that mentions a shield, although you cannot convert it into a magic shield, or vice versa. Improvised shields are typically not as sturdy and may break during combat, becoming unusable as a shield. *While a DM may decide this at any point, a suggested way of choosing if an improvised shield breaks is to roll a d6 whenever an attack roll misses due to the shield's AC bonus—if a character would normally have a 16 AC, and their improvised shield increases this to 18, then a 17 on the attack roll is blocked by the shield. If the d6 rolls a 5 or 6, the damage is enough to break the shield; otherwise, the object can continue being used as a shield. This range can be increased or decreased based on the strength of the object used or the power of the attack blocked, if need be; this is simply a suggested method of handling improvised shield durability.*

The Best Defense...

Also at 3rd level, you have practiced with using your shield for offensive purposes, should the need arise. Shields count as simple melee weapons for you. If your shield has a magic bonus, you can add that to the attack and damage rolls of your shield.

A standard shield deals 2d4 bludgeoning damage on a hit and has the *thrown (15/30)* and *returning* weapon property for you. When you throw your shield, you can unequip it without needing to use an action, and when you use the *returning* property, you can re-equip it as a free action.

A buckler deals 1d4 bludgeoning damage on a hit and has the *light* and *finesse* weapon properties.

A tower shield deals 2d4 bludgeoning damage on a hit and has the *heavy* weapon property.

Improvised shields deal 2d4 bludgeoning damage on a hit, but they have no weapon properties. A DM may rule that a particular object is similar enough to one of the other shield types and use those statistics, though.

If you are playing with the revised 2024 ruleset, shields share a single weapon mastery slot; that is, if you can use the weapon mastery property of one kind of shield, you can also use the weapon mastery properties of the other shields. Bucklers have the Graze weapon mastery, standard and improvised shields have the Sap mastery, and tower shields have the Cleave mastery.

Rallying Cry

Starting at 7th level, you can let out a rallying cry as a Bonus Action. All creatures of your choice within 30 feet of you gain temporary hit points equal to your Fighter level. You can also use this feature whenever you Action Surge without using a Bonus Action or expending a use of this feature. You can use this feature a number of times equal to your Constitution modifier (minimum 1); you regain all expended uses on a long rest, and one expended use on a short rest.

Unyielding Presence

Beginning at level 10, your training has improved your resilience and allowed you to resist foes who would see you removed from the battle. Whenever you roll Initiative or use either Action Surge or Indomitable, you can choose to expend a hit die; assume the maximum die roll and add your Constitution modifier, regaining hit points equal to the total.

Additionally, whenever you fail a saving throw, you can choose to use your AC in place of your result, potentially turning the failure into a success. If the result still fails, you do not expend your use of this feature. You regain the ability to use this feature whenever you complete a short or long rest.

Note: Whenever this feature or another references using your AC as the result of a roll, use your current AC value at that given moment, including benefits from effects like half-cover.

Versatile Defenses

Starting at 15th level, you have improved your ability to react and adapt to whatever situations you find yourself in. You gain an additional Reaction on each of your turns, allowing you to use two Reactions instead of one.

Additionally, whenever you use Indomitable or Unyielding Presence, you can use Rallying Cry as part of it without expending one of its uses; this applies the temporary hit points prior to any damage or effects caused by determining the results of the saving throw.

Unbreakable

Starting at level 18, your presence grants your allies strength in the face of your foes. While a creature has temporary hit points and is within 30 feet of you, if you consider them an ally and you are not Incapacitated, the results of their saving throws can never be lower than your AC.

Also at 18th level, you can use your Unyielding Presence feature twice per short or long rest, instead of once.